

BANDEEP SINGH

COVER STORY: MARRIAGES

NETRIMONY

66

Forget horoscopes. Ignore caste. Online matrimonial sites are changing the rules of the mating game and becoming an electronic vehicle for social change in Indian society.



STATES: KERALA



Old Battle New Ground 42

With the attack on CPI(M)'s national headquarters in AKG Bhavan in Delhi, the RSS-Marxist revenge killings are all set to cross the state border.

BUSINESS & ECONOMY: YELLOW METAL

Gold Rush

46

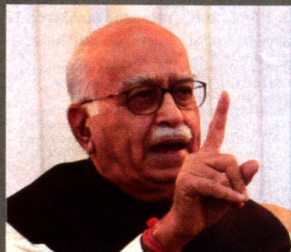
An ever-weakening US dollar, stagnant output, rising consumption and spooked stock markets push prices of the yellow metal to new highs as investors turn to safe havens.



MANDAR DEODHAR

NATION: ADVANI'S MEMOIRS

Unrepentant 18

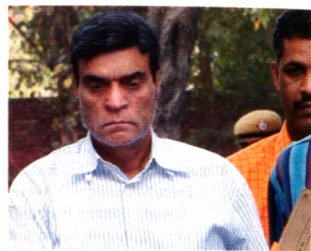


A massive attempt in self-vindication, L.K. Advani's autobiography coincides with his last chance to become prime minister.

DEFENCE: BARAK DEAL

Barak Backfire

54



The Central Bureau of Investigation nabs India's biggest arms agent in a case involving the purchase of Barak missiles.

SPORTS: HOCKEY

Lost Glory

76



The team that gave India its Olympic footprint will be missing from Beijing. Run by autocratic officials, this Olympian trauma is self-inflicted.

SOCIETY & THE ARTS: MUSIC

Melody Matters 86

Independent artistes and small no-name bands find a messiah in cult record labels that promise to break the drudgery of Bollywood beats.

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Jobs Today Turn to pg 94

Take a look at the latest job offers in the Market.

COVER BY SAURABH SINGH
COVER PHOTOGRAPH BY BANDEEP SINGH
Hair & Makeup by Pretty Nianguh; Outfits by Satya
Paul and JJ Vallaya from Samsaara